



STUDY GUIDE

Qalam-e-Qirtas (LITERATURE)

Category Overview

Qalam o Qirtas takes participants through all the elements of Urdu poetry, from testing knowledge of renowned poets, to writing their own pieces, to reciting them. This category allows participants to fully express themselves through our mother language.

Round 1: Hajoom-e-Ilm

In this round, participants will be tested on their knowledge of all our most well-known and appreciated poets. They would have to guess a randomly chosen poet by asking questions about him/her.

Delegates are required to know information about the following:

Allama Iqbal, Mirza Ghalib, Mir Taqi Mir, Ahmad Faraz, Faiz Ahmed Faiz, Mirza Mehmood Sarhadi, Jaun Elia, Parveen Shakir, Mushtaq Ahmad Yousafi, Nasir Kazmi, Ibn-e-Insha, Munir Niazi, Noon Meem Rashid, Sahir Ludhianvi, Daagh Dehlvi, Ismat Chughtai, Qurratulain Hyder, Ashfaq Ahmed, Bano Qudsia, Saadat Hasan Manto.

Judging Criteria

Number of Questions	-(X * 3)
Above Time Limit	-30
No Effort	-60
TOTAL	100

Rules:

- Delegate Cap: 2
- Cheating of any kind will not be tolerated.
- Display of offensive behaviour will result in immediate disqualification.
- Teams must adhere strictly to the 7-minute window

Round 2: Darbar-e-Ghalib (Poetry)

In this round, teams will be able to express themselves through the use of their 'Qalam'. The teams will be given 2 random topics to write poetry on. This round tests the ability of participants to adapt and thrive in unusual circumstances using their knowledge on Urdu poetry to create a piece of their own.

After receiving the writing elements, participants will have 2 hours to write their poems. Officials will not provide any help but will be present in the room. Participants must adhere to the time limit, or else negative marking will be applied. Participants must write at least 3 sher (6 couplets), with a limit of 6-7 sher.



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Judging Criteria:

Criterion	Marks
Incorporation Of Elements	15
Vocabulary	15
Originality	15
Creativity	15
TOTAL	60

Rules:

- Delegate Cap: 2
- 2 hours
- Use of AI is strictly prohibited

Round 3: Recitation:

The qualified teams will now recite the pieces of writing, however, not their own. They will be randomly given the writings of other teams and will be asked to recite them in front of everyone. This round tests improvisation.

Teams will be given 30 minutes to read and rehearse their recitations, or even memorise them. The teams must be prepared within 30 minutes or else they will be disqualified.

Teams will be called forward and shall recite their allotted pieces of writing in front of the officials and judges. They have a maximum of 5 minutes to finish their recitations.

Judging Criteria:

Criterion	Marks
Body Language	10
Melody	10
Confidence	10
Repetition	10
Time Management	10
Carry-forward: Rounds 1 + 2 (160 points × 31%)	~50
TOTAL	100

Rules:

- Delegate Cap: 1